



Lexus goes Electric!

Lexus is set to release their first ever electric vehicle on the 20th of April.
<https://digit.in/apr22-33>



Not these Tokens again

China's WeChat recently deleted quite a few accounts promoting NFTs in the country.
<https://digit.in/apr22-34>

LG ToneFree FP9

Super comfortable UV- Cleansing Earbuds

LG's lineup of ToneFree earphones incorporates Meridian sound technology and the ones we've reviewed before definitely impressed us. We now have LG's latest top-of-the-line TWS earphones called the LG ToneFree FP9. Are these earphones good enough to recommend amidst the sea of contenders though? Let's find out.

BUILD AND COMFORT

The LG ToneFree FP9's charging case has a circular charging case with a small footprint. The matte finish of the case is pleasing to the touch and avoids fingerprints or smudges. The case is lightweight and easy to open one-handed. When you open the case, it glows blue, presumably to drive home the UV cleansing capabilities. There's a toggle on the left to switch to wireless transmitter mode, which we will talk about later. The buds look simple and slightly bland, to be honest. The back of the stem has a slight glow but that's the only aesthetic flair. The top of the stems houses the touch panels that work exceedingly well with few misreadings. The buds are extremely lightweight and comfortable to wear. They barely slip out of the ears even when you're walking or jogging, which is impressive.

FEATURES

The ToneFree FP9 come with a plethora of features. Let's first speak about two of its most unique features. Starting with UVNano technology. The FP9's case uses UV light to automatically clean your earbuds. This reduces bacteria on the inner-ear mesh by up to 99.9% in 5 minutes when on charge, according to LG.

UV cleansing isn't the only unique feature though. The FP9's charging case also doubles as a wireless dongle or transmitter that allow the earbuds to be used with non-Bluetooth devices.



There's a toggle on the left side of the case that needs to be turned on. Then, using the provided USB-C to aux cable, the charging case can be plugged into any device with a 3.5mm input such as a gaming console or an in-flight entertainment system. The user can then simply remove the earbuds from the case and listen to media wirelessly without using Bluetooth. It's an extremely innovative and unique feature, and during our testing, the feature worked well.

The earphones also come with Active Noise Cancellation and Ambient Mode support. The ANC, while not as effective as competitors such as the Sony WF-1000XM4 and Bose QuietComfort Earbuds, is pretty decent.

The earbuds also come with app support. They use the Tone Free app that provides users access to plenty of features and customisations such as EQ control, voice alerts, and more.

PERFORMANCE

As with previous ToneFree earphones, LG has once again partnered with Meridian, a British manufacturer of high-fidelity audio components and

systems, for the FP9. The earphones are equipped with 8mm drivers and you get SBC and AAC audio codec support. Meridian-tuned audio and improved drivers equate to an immersive and refined sonic experience.

The earbuds provide detailed and natural sound rivalled by very few in the consumer TWS segment. Meridian's expertise in surround sound really shows with these earbuds. The bass is controlled, the mids are detailed and the highs sound impactful.

BATTERY LIFE

The FP9's battery life is nothing worth writing home about. The earbuds feature a wireless playback time of 6 hours with ANC turned on, which is decent, but in total, you can get only 15 hours of total playback time with the charging case, which is mediocre at best. In our tests, with ANC on, the earbuds lasted a little over 5 hours and the case provided a charge and a half.



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VERDICT

The LG ToneFree FP9 stands out in the sea of TWS offerings due to features such as UV cleansing, and the case doubling as a wireless transmitter. They're easily one of the most interesting pairs of earphones we've tested and if you're a tech enthusiast, you may be able to spend hours exploring the different features. Once you get tired of exploring though, you have a solid pair of earbuds complete with excellent fit, immersive sound quality, decent battery life, and a great companion app packed with customisation options.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

WEIGHT: Approx. 52 g x2 | HEADPHONE TYPE: Closed, dynamic | DRIVER SIZE: 8mm | BATTERY LIFE (EARBUDS): 10 hours (without ANC) | BATTERY LIFE (WITH CASE): 24-hours (without ANC) | CHARGING METHOD: USB Type-C | BLUETOOTH VERSION: 5.2 | EFFECTIVE RANGE: 10m | SUPPORTED AUDIO CODECS: SBC, AAC

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